

Elder Abuse Reporting Policy

Effective Date: June 1, 2026 | Version 1.0

Purpose

This policy outlines Good Company's obligations and procedures for identifying and reporting suspected elder abuse, neglect, or exploitation. Compliance with Michigan mandatory reporting laws and the protection of vulnerable adult clients is a core responsibility of every member of the Good Company team.

Legal Authority

Michigan law (The Social Welfare Act, Sections 11(a)–11(k)) requires individuals working with vulnerable adults to report suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation to Michigan Adult Protective Services. Good Company staff are considered mandatory reporters under this law.

Reports to Adult Protective Services can be made anonymously, and are typically kept confidential subject to disclosure with the consent of the reporter or by judicial process; and good-faith reporters are protected from civil and criminal liability.

Definitions

The following forms of elder abuse are reportable under this policy:

- Physical abuse: any non-accidental physical or mental injury or maltreatment.
- Exploitation including misuse of an adult's funds, property or personal dignity.

Warning Signs to Watch For

Staff should be alert to indicators that may suggest abuse, neglect, or exploitation:

- Unexplained bruises, cuts, burns, or injuries
- Bruises in patterns suggesting restraint or being struck
- Sudden weight loss, dehydration, or signs of malnutrition
- Poor hygiene, soiled clothing, or unclean living conditions
- Bedsores or untreated medical conditions
- Withdrawal, fearfulness, or unusual quietness around certain individuals
- Sudden changes in financial situation, missing belongings, or new "friends" with access to finances
- Documents signed by the client that they do not appear to understand
- A caregiver or family member who refuses to allow the client to be alone with you
- Statements from the client suggesting they are being mistreated

Reporting Procedure

If a Good Company staff member suspects abuse, neglect, or exploitation, the following procedure must be followed:

1. If the client is in immediate danger, call 911 first.
2. Report the suspicion to Michigan Adult Protective Services within 24 hours by calling 855-444-3911 (available 24/7) or by visiting michigan.gov/mdhhs.
3. Document the observations in writing immediately: what was observed, when, where, who was present, and any statements made by the client.
4. Notify the Good Company owner of the report. Do not delay the report to consult internally first.
5. Do not confront the suspected abuser or attempt to investigate further.
6. Continue providing services as scheduled unless instructed otherwise by Adult Protective Services or law enforcement.
7. Maintain confidentiality regarding the report. Do not discuss with family members, neighbors, or other parties.

Reporter Protections

Michigan law protects mandatory reporters who make good-faith reports of suspected abuse:

- Reports may be made anonymously
- Reporters acting in good faith are immune from civil or criminal liability
- Retaliation against a reporter is prohibited by law
- The identity of the reporter is kept confidential by Adult Protective Services

Documentation

All reports made under this policy must be documented in Good Company's internal records.

Documentation includes:

- Date and time of observation
- Specific observations (objective, non-judgmental descriptions)
- Date, time, and means of report to Adult Protective Services
- Name of person who received the report (if provided)
- Reference or case number (if assigned)
- Any follow-up communication from Adult Protective Services or law enforcement

Records Retention

Records related to a report of suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation are retained permanently and are never destroyed. Storage, security, and access for these records follow the Records Retention Policy. Because of the sensitive nature of these records, access is limited to the Owner and to authorized law enforcement or regulatory agencies acting under proper legal authority.

Confidentiality

Information related to a report is strictly confidential and is only shared with Adult Protective Services, law enforcement, or other authorized parties. Discussion with family members, other clients, or the general public is prohibited.

Policy Review and Training

This policy is reviewed annually. All staff members are required to read this policy and complete an acknowledgment before providing services. Refresher training is provided annually.

Policy reviewed and approved by:



Natalie Perras, Owner

Date: 6/9/2026